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CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

CARIBBEAN SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE®
EXAMINATION

ENGLISH B

Paper 01 – General Proficiency

*1 hour 45 minutes***READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS CAREFULLY.**

1. This paper consists of THREE questions. Each question is worth 20 marks.
2. Answer ALL questions.
3. Write your answers in the spaces provided in this answer booklet.
4. Do NOT write in the margins.
5. You are advised to take some time to read through the paper and plan your answers.
6. If you need to rewrite any answer and there is not enough space to do so on the original page, you must use the extra lined page(s) provided at the back of this booklet. **Remember to draw a line through your original answer.**
7. **If you use the extra page(s) you MUST write the question number clearly in the box provided at the top of the extra page(s) and, where relevant, include the question part beside the answer.**

DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

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SECTION A – DRAMA

1. Read the following extract carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

Monday Morning

Miss LEAH is in the back sitting with MINNIE who is lying down. FAN is alone in the kitchen where she checks the time and then goes to the oven and takes out a perfect pie. FRANK enters the yard furtively. FAN sees him and watches him from the window. She takes off her apron and goes to the door. She opens it before he knocks. He steps back, startled.

FAN: Come in, Frank.

(FRANK hesitates.)

FAN: Sister's gone to town and Miss Leah's in the back with Min. Please. Come in.

FRANK: Parrish said you were going to come into the land office with me. Are you ready?

10 FAN: It's all right. Sister isn't angry anymore. She wants to make you an offer.

FRANK: What kind of offer?

FAN: Please. Come inside so we can talk.

FRANK: I don't want any trouble.

FAN: We're prepared to make you an offer for your land.

15 FRANK: You can't afford what they're paying in town.

FAN: We're prepared to pay exactly what they're paying in town.

FRANK: You don't have that kind of money. Minnie said so.

FAN: Sister and I didn't involve Min in all the details of our household finances. I'll go into town with you now and we can make all the arrangements. Do you have the deed?

20 *(FRANK shows it and puts it back in his pocket.)*

FAN: Good!

FRANK: That's fine by me. I don't care where the money comes from as long as it ends up in my pocket so I can get the hell out of this place! *(Extends his hand)* Can we seal the deal, Fannie? Just the two of us?

25 FAN: Done.

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



FRANK: You know, I'm sorry it had to go this far in the first place. I love Minnie... How is she?

FAN: She's asleep right now. Miss Leah's with her.

FRANK: Good, good.

30 FAN: She wanted me to wake her up as soon as you got here, but I told her to get a few more minutes rest and I'd give you a piece of homemade apple pie to keep you busy in the meantime.

FRANK: You're not angry with me? About Min, I mean. You know how aggravating she can be some time. She's such a child.

35 FAN: I understand. She has to understand that a wife's first allegiance is to her husband.

FRANK: Well, you're a very understanding person and I appreciate that, but I would just as soon we get on our way. I don't think your sister would be too happy to come home and find me sitting at her table eating up all her...

40 FAN: (*Holding out a piece to him*)... apple pie. My specialty. Sister won't be home for hours yet. Besides, now that we know we'll be able to keep the land in the family, Sister's not one to hold a grudge.

FRANK: I don't know about that.

45 FAN: We've got to put all that misunderstanding behind us now. For Min's sake and for the sake of your baby. I know Sister is prepared to let bygones be bygones. In fact, when she saw me rolling out the crust for this pie, she told me to make sure you got a piece of it.

50 FRANK: She did? Well, it takes a better man than I am to refuse an invitation for a piece of your famous pie! (*He sits and begins to eat heartily.*) Delicious! (*Laughs, coughs a little*) Soon as we get everything signed and proper, goodbye Niggerdemus! Hello London! They treat me like a human being over there. Half the people we know don't even know I'm coloured. I told Min if she was just a couple of shades lighter, we could travel first class all over the world. Nobody would suspect a thing. (*Laughs, coughs a little, loosens his tie*). I just let people draw their own conclusions. (*Coughs harder as FAN watches impassively*) Can you get me a glass of water, please? I feel a little...strange.

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FAN: No, FRANK I can't do that.

FRANK: Please! I... water... my throat's on fire! (*He suddenly realizes.*)

Adapted from Pearl Cleage, "Flyin' West." In Kathy A. Perkins and Roberta Uno (eds), Contemporary Plays by Women of Color: An Anthology, Routledge, 1996, pp.75-76.



- (a) Where is the event taking place? Support your answer with evidence from the extract.

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(2 marks)

- (b) Describe what is happening in lines 6–15 (“Come in Frank... paying in town”).

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(3 marks)

- (c) What does the audience learn about Fan’s character from lines 39 to 54 (“*Holding out a piece...grudge*”) and the stage direction in lines 53–54 (“*Coughs harder as ... impassively*”)?

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(4 marks)

- (d) Although Minne is offstage, we learn of her relationship with her husband, Frank. Describe Frank’s attitude towards Minnie. Support your answer with evidence from the extract.

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(3 marks)

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(e) Comment on the dramatic significance of ONE of the following props:

- The apple pie
- The deed

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(3 marks)

(f) Identify ONE theme portrayed in the extract. Support your answer with evidence from the extract.

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(2 marks)

(g) Identify and explain ONE example of dramatic irony.

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(3 marks)

Total 20 marks



SECTION B – POETRY

2. Read the following poem carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

Swimming Lesson

My mother is teaching me to swim
staying afloat in the clear aqua
is a struggle for her she wants me
to be better than her stirs up
5 the sand when she goes darkens
the clear and swims like one a them trapped
blue marlin butting and butting my uncle's boat
thrashing the line of the Sunday deep sea killers
trawling in the blood past the reef
10 one hand on their rods, the other on their Chivas Regal ¹.

In the water where she can stand
she says swim to me now
and I begin the crossing
clumsy laborious spluttering
15 banging my little bones
the disparate pieces of arm
leg shoulder against the angles
of the deep water, pausing
gulping between splattering on
20 longing to reach her body's harbor.

As I am about to reach, to rest
'Come on, come come come man,' she laughs
and moves further off again
I am tired. Kicking angry. Shicoom. Shicoom.
25 Glugging up through the bubbles
the hard blue for air and the misty sands
blur the water so I never reach the end
this homeless groundless body
struggling not to fight
30 the water not to thrash
to flash streamlined like the conquering
trawler gliding into port.

¹ whisky

Honor Ford-Smith, "Swimming Lesson." In Stewart Brown
and Mark McWatt(eds) *Oxford Book of Caribbean Verse*,
Oxford University Press, 2005, p. 264.

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



- (a) Describe what is taking place in the poem and where it is happening.

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(2 marks)

- (b) State how the speaker's attitude to the mother changes. Support your answer with evidence from the poem.

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(2 marks)

- (c) (i) Identify the dominant image in the poem.

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(1 mark)

- (ii) Comment on ONE technique used by the poet to reinforce this image.

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(2 marks)



- (d) Identify the figurative device in ONE of the following lines of the poem and comment on its effectiveness:

- “darkens/the clear and swims like one a them trapped/blue marlin” (lines 5–7)
- “Shicoom. Shicoom.” (line 24)

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(3 marks)

- (e) Explain how the speaker’s tone changes in stanzas 1 and 3.

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(3 marks)

- (f) Comment on the effectiveness of the following lines:

- (i) “Glugging up through the bubbles/the hard blue for air” (lines 25–26).

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(2 marks)

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- (ii) “this homeless groundless body/struggling not to fight/the water” (lines 28–30).

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(2 marks)

- (g) Comment on the effect of the mother’s voice on the speaker.

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(3 marks)

Total 20 marks



SECTION C – PROSE FICTION

3. Read the following extract carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

I fervently wished, on the morning of the tryouts, that my hair was not arranged in cornrows across the top of my head. That morning the Parish Hall was empty of chairs and flooded with sunlight streaming in from the many doors which reached from ceiling to polished floor. Faded red curtains were drawn across the stage, below which stood the upright piano, at which Sister Mary Ursula sat, singing the song our class was to perform in the annual school entertainment.

I wanted to be the girl who would sing the solo, up front, near the footlights. In my mind, I heard myself singing. My mother's pale, oval face would glow with pride and my father's dimples would deepen in his brown cheeks.

That morning Sister Ursula's voice planted inspiration in my heart, and I raised my hand to compete for the solo with Merrie Mercer. She was petite, pretty, and as pious as the angels in our prayer books. Her voice was melodious and so soft, I could hardly hear the words over the sound of the piano. "And in every shop window, I'd primp passing by," she sang, patting her thick, glossy curls. On the final note, she held out one end of her navy skirt and made a quick curtsy, like a genuflection. The class applause was long and enthusiastic.

When it was my turn, I stood stiff and straight with my hands clenched at my sides, as though I was about to sing the colony's anthem before a crowd of thousands. I wanted to sing with lightness and gaiety as Sister Ursula had done earlier that morning. I couldn't. I thought of my parents who might get a seat at the rear of the hall, and I sang as loudly and as sincerely as I could. The girls fidgeted. Some yawned or looked through the doorway at Mr Charlie, our aged janitor, leaning on his broom, gazing at me, and sympathy in his rheumy eyes. "You should have known better," he seemed to say. Josie Hale, the oldest girl in the class, covered her mouth as though to keep from laughing.

*Adapted from Zee Edgell, "The Entertainment."
In Elizabeth Nunez and Jennifer Sparrow (eds),
Caribbean Women Writers at Home and Abroad
Seal Press, 2006, pp. 95–97.*

- (a) Identify the setting of the extract.

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(1 mark)

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- (b) Suggest TWO reasons why the narrator wanted to sing the solo at the annual entertainment.

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(2 marks)

- (c) Describe the central conflict in the extract.

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(3 marks)

- (d) State TWO characteristics of the narrator. Support EACH response with evidence from the extract.

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(4 marks)

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- (e) Identify the literary device used in, “petite, pretty and as pious as the angels in our prayer books” (lines 10–11) and comment on its effectiveness.

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(3 marks)

- (f) Discuss the writer’s use of contrast in the extract.

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(4 marks)

- (g) Suggest ONE reason why the writer included Mr Charlie’s response to the narrator’s performance. Support your response with evidence from the extract.

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(3 marks)

Total 20 marks

END OF TEST

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